

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: The central question of regime classification and its four axes

CENTRAL QUESTION -> by what title may one arrangement of rule bind everyone in a territory, and on what grounds may that arrangement be judged?

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FOUR AXES, NEVER ONE

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|------------------------|--|
| (1) WHO RULES? | one few many |
| (2) FOR WHOSE GOOD? | common good <--> private or sectional interest |
| (3) BY WHAT TITLE? | heredity conquest divine sanction
consent and election sacred law |
| (4) UNDER WHAT LIMITS? | law? rights? accountability? none at all? |

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MONARCHY

rule of one; title is
heredity, tradition and
sometimes divine right

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danger: arbitrariness,
unaccountability, a weak
basis in equality

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DESCRIPTIVE map (what a regime IS) vs NORMATIVE verdict (whether it OUGHT to bind)

CONTROL -> separate the four axes first, fix description or evaluation second,
adjudicate last on a criterion you have already named.

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THEOCRACY

rule in the name of God;
title is revelation and
sacred law read by clergy

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danger: conscience crushed,
citizenship made unequal,
dissent read as impiety

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DEMOCRACY

rule of the people;
title is consent,
equality, participation

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danger: majoritarianism,
manipulated opinion,
mediocrity, propaganda

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Plato: the degeneration sequence and the three charges against democracy

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ROOT CLAIM -> ruling is a CRAFT requiring KNOWLEDGE of justice and the good
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SHIP OF STATE -> navigation is not handed to the unskilled because they are many
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DEGENERATION OF CONSTITUTIONS (Republic): each dominant value corrupts into the next
  ARISTOCRACY OF KNOWLEDGE -- wisdom rules
    | honour displaces wisdom
    v
  TIMOCRACY -- honour and military spiritedness
    | the desire for wealth displaces honour
    v
  OLIGARCHY -- property and wealth; rich divided from poor
    | the poor many overthrow the propertied few
    v
  DEMOCRACY -- freedom and equality of desires
    | unrestrained licence makes restraint itself look oppressive
    v
  TYRANNY -- one demagogue who flatters the many, then dominates them
    |
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THREE CHARGES -> [1] ruling is a craft, so numbers confer no competence
                  -> [2] democracy mistakes LIBERTY for QUALIFICATION
                  -> [3] unregulated liberty breeds the demagogue, hence tyranny
TRAP -> this is NOT a defence of hereditary monarchy and NOT mere hatred of freedom
VERDICT (asymmetric) -> the diagnosis of demagoguery and defective leadership-
  selection survives; the guardian remedy fails for want of consent and correction.
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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Aristotle's six-fold matrix and the polity as the practicable mean

TWO VARIABLES -> [A] HOW MANY RULE [B] FOR WHOSE ADVANTAGE

+-----+-----+-----+-----+	
NUMBER RULING	RIGHT FORM (common good) DEVIATION (private gain)
+-----+-----+-----+-----+	
ONE	MONARCHY TYRANNY
FEW	ARISTOCRACY OLIGARCHY
MANY	POLITY DEMOCRACY (classical sense)
+-----+-----+-----+-----+	

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KEY -> the right and corrupt version of each number differ in PURPOSE, not in SIZE;
the good-MANY form is POLITY, and classical democracy is its DEVIATION

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POLITY = mixed constitution -> rule of the many UNDER LAW, moderated by property,
virtue, civic participation and a broad MIDDLE CLASS
against STATISM -> value is not absorbed into one all-wise ruler or state
against INDIVIDUALISM -> politics is not unrestricted private self-assertion
for CIVIC MODERATION -> citizenship inside a lawful order aimed at common good

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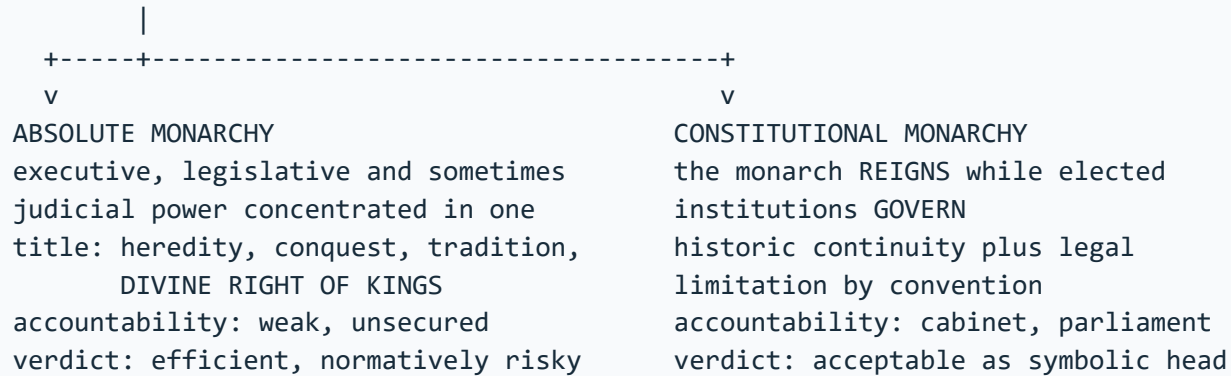
PLATO asks WHO OUGHT IDEALLY TO RULE | ARISTOTLE asks WHICH CONSTITUTION CAN
| SUSTAIN good political life in practice

LIMIT -> common advantage is not self-specifying and needs an independent theory of
the good; the stability of polity is a sociological claim, not a proof.

TRAP -> polity is a mixed-government precursor, NOT universal-suffrage democracy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Monarchy: two types, four objections and the above-politics test

DEFINITION -> rule by ONE person, normally holding office by HEREDITY



FOUR OBJECTIONS TO HEREDITARY RULE AS A PRINCIPLE

EQUALITY -> public authority should be open to all on equal terms
MERIT -> birth guarantees neither wisdom nor virtue
ACCOUNTABILITY -> concentrated power invites arbitrariness and despotism
FREEDOM -> liberty needs law, rights and institutions, not a crown

THE ABOVE-POLITICS TEST

above PARTY CONFLICT -> systematic: the role is fixed by convention and the
elected institutions retain governance
above CONSTITUTIONAL ACCOUNTABILITY -> not systematic: the order ceases to be
constitutional and slides toward arbitrary rule

DIVINE RIGHT -> the king rules by God's will and answers primarily to God: a BRIDGE
between monarchy and theocracy, never an identity of the two
VERDICT -> monarchy coexists with individual freedom only where CONSTITUTIONALISED;
as a principle of rule it does not by itself ground freedom.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Theocracy: divine sovereignty, the interpretation monopoly and validity

DEFINITION -> political authority claimed in the name of GOD, of divine law, or of the authorised interpreters of sacred truth

NOT the same as -> a society merely INFLUENCED by religion, or a morally informed polity in which believers argue publicly as equal citizens

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FIVE STRUCTURAL FEATURES

SOVEREIGNTY OF GOD -> final authority is divine will, not the people

SACRED LAW -> religious law guides or determines civil law

CLERICAL MEDIATION -> priests, jurists and elites interpret divine command

LIMITED PLURALISM -> dissent is constrained as theological deviance

FUSION -> political and religious legitimacy overlap

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CASE FOR	CASE AGAINST
moral unity and collective purpose	no equal standing for other faiths or none
restraint on self-interested politics	liberty of conscience is compromised
a stable ethical order derived from sacred obligation	dissent becomes impiety, not disagreement
a higher law above human rulers	interpretation becomes a clerical MONOPOLY
	adaptation to rights discourse is hard

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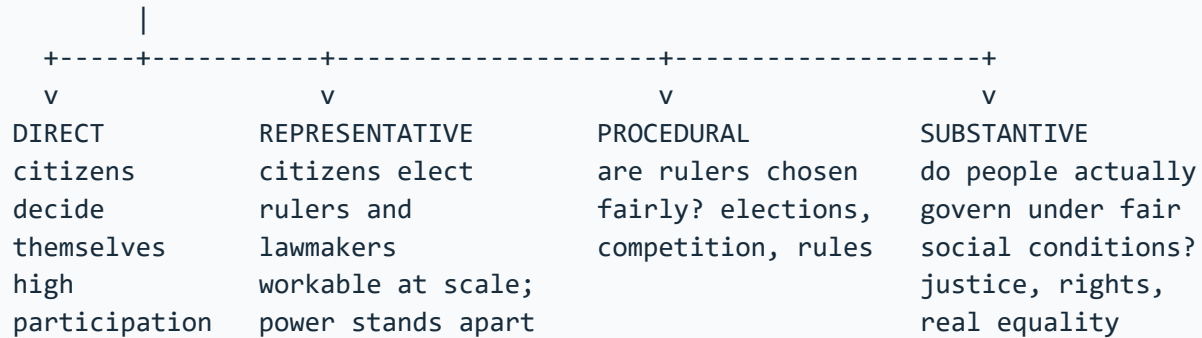
THE DECISIVE PROBLEM -> WHO SPEAKS FOR GOD? once interpretation is human, theological certainty can mask ordinary struggles for power

SECULARISM -> the state is not founded on the supremacy of one religious truth for all; it protects equal citizenship, liberty of conscience and coexistence
(India: Articles 25-28 guarantee freedom of conscience and religion subject to public order, morality and health, and bar religious instruction in wholly State-funded institutions -- dated legal facts, not proof of a thesis)

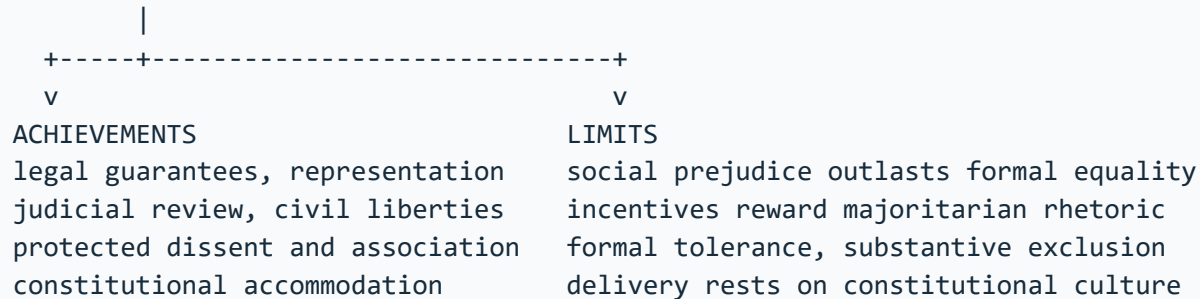
VERDICT -> internally valid for believers; as a GENERAL form of government in a plural modern society it fails consent, equal citizenship and revision.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Democracy: the model taxonomy and the protection of minorities

DEFINITION -> rule of the people: political equality, consent, participation, accountability, public justification and protection of rights



LIBERAL DEMOCRACY = popular rule + constitutional limits + rights + rule of law
-> the majority governs WITHOUT converting number into unrestricted power



DEEPENING MODELS -> PARTICIPATORY: participation educates citizens and resists alienation, echoing Mill on public character
-> DELIBERATIVE: Habermas grounds legitimacy in public reasoning under freedom, reciprocity and absence of domination
-> EPISTEMIC: procedures allow error-detection and revision

INDIA ANCHOR -> Ambedkar warns that political equality cannot long survive amid deep social and economic inequality.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Authority and legitimacy: the Weberian grid laid across the classical one

POWER = compliance secured despite resistance | AUTHORITY = power believed RIGHTFUL

TYPE	GROUND OF BELIEF	ADMINISTRATION	SUCCESSION
TRADITIONAL	sanctity of immemorial custom	personal retainers, patrimonial staff	inheritance or custom
CHARISMATIC	devotion to an exceptional leader	disciples chosen personally, no rules	acute; the type is frail
LEGAL-RATIONAL	legality of enacted rules	BUREAUCRACY: office, files, career	impersonal, by rule

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THE TYPOLOGY CUTS ACROSS THE CLASSICAL GRID

monarchy -> traditional, occasionally charismatic

theocracy -> traditional joined to charismatic

democracy -> normally legal-rational, yet capturable by plebiscitary charisma

ROUTINISATION OF CHARISMA -> movement becomes party becomes bureaucracy

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SCHUMPETER -> democracy is the COMPETITIVE STRUGGLE FOR THE PEOPLE'S VOTE; the

people's function is to PRODUCE A GOVERNMENT, not to govern (procedural pole)

MICHELIS, Political Parties (1911) -> IRON LAW OF OLIGARCHY: scale, specialisation

and control of information entrench a permanent leadership

TRAP -> Weberian legitimacy is a SOCIOLOGICAL fact about belief, never a normative

certificate of justification; ideal types are yardsticks, not portraits

VERDICT -> number of rulers tells us WHO decides; type of legitimacy tells us WHY

they are obeyed, and a complete assessment requires both grids.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Populism, illiberal democracy and the manufacture of consent

DEFINITIONAL CONTEST -> state it, never settle it silently

MUDDE (2004) -> populism as a THIN-CENTRED ideology: a pure people against a corrupt elite, attaching to a HOST ideology across the spectrum

MULLER (2016) -> the decisive move is EXCLUSIVE MORAL REPRESENTATION: rivals are not opponents but enemies of the people (ANTI-PLURALISM)

LACLAU (2005) -> populism as a LOGIC OF ARTICULATION binding unsatisfied demands into a collective subject called the people

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THE SLIDE, STEP BY STEP

[1] a genuine representation deficit exists

[2] a leader articulates the excluded demands and claims to embody the people

[3] the people is defined MORALLY, so disagreement becomes betrayal

[4] courts, chambers, commissions, press and federal units become obstructions

[5] they are weakened, captured or bypassed while elections continue

[6] result -> ILLIBERAL DEMOCRACY

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FORM RETAINED		SUBSTANCE ERODED
elections continue		fairness of contest: access, finance, media, disputes
a majority governs		limits on what a majority may do to minorities
courts function		independence of appointment, tenure and enforcement
a press exists		plurality of ownership, absence of indirect pressure
opposition parties exist		a realistic prospect of alternation in power

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PROPAGANDA -> a judgment is the citizen's own only under access to information, rival argument and freedom from manipulation; otherwise consent is MANUFACTURED and a vote confers sociological legitimacy without normative authorisation

REGULATOR'S DILEMMA -> content-based remedies hand the state power over public truth, the very power a propagandising state abuses

STRUCTURAL REMEDIES -> plural ownership, transparent political finance, independent electoral adjudication, protected journalism, civic education, rights of reply

CAUTION -> a diagnostic grid only; no country, party, leader or period is judged.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Where power sits: unitary against federal design and subsidiarity

SECOND AXIS (comparative scaffolding, clearly labelled -- not owned doctrine)
WHO RULES is one question; WHERE POWER SITS and HOW FAR DOWN it goes is another

UNITARY <-----> FEDERAL	
one central government;	a constitutional DIVISION of powers
sub-units exercise DELEGATED	between centre and units, each with
powers it may withdraw	a guaranteed sphere
uniformity and decisiveness,	autonomy, diversity-management and a
at the price of remoteness	check on central overreach, at the
	price of coordination and deadlock

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+----- STABILISERS -----+
    bicameralism: a chamber for the units
    a JUDICIAL UMPIRE over the centre-unit boundary
    fiscal and intergovernmental machinery
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VARIETIES -> COMING-TOGETHER federation: independent states unite
-> HOLDING-TOGETHER federation: one polity devolves to hold diversity
-> FEDERATION (one indissoluble sovereignty) against CONFEDERATION
(sovereign members, exit possible, weak centre)

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SUBSIDIARITY -> decide at the LOWEST capable level

CENTRE -> STATE / PROVINCE -> DISTRICT -> LOCAL SELF-GOVERNMENT
(panchayats and municipalities)

INDIA (dated legal facts) -> Article 40 directs the State to organise village panchayats as units of self-government; the 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment Acts, 1992 added Parts IX and IX-A. India is a parliamentary, holding-together federal republic under CONSTITUTIONAL SUPREMACY with judicial review -- never parliamentary sovereignty

GANDHI -> village self-rule (swaraj): self-reliant, participatory village republics

CONTROL -> keep the axis subordinate and return to source, purpose and limits.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: The answer spine: shared axes, directive decoder and the graded verdict

STEP 1 DEFINE -> name the form by its SOURCE OF AUTHORITY, not by a caricature
STEP 2 LOCATE -> place the stem on the classical grid AND the legitimacy grid
STEP 3 RIVALS -> stage ONE real debate, never three disconnected mini-essays
STEP 4 OBJECT -> voice the strongest objection to your own thesis, then reply
STEP 5 EVIDENCE -> one unit at 10 marks, two at 15, four or five at 20
STEP 6 VERDICT -> graded, conceding something to the losing side

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RUN ALL THREE FORMS DOWN THE SAME AXES

source of authority | type of legitimacy claimed | succession or selection
accountability | relation to law | treatment of dissent | equal citizenship
CAPACITY TO CORRECT ERROR <- the axis that usually decides and is usually left out

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DIRECTIVE DECODER -- the verb fixes the structure

Comment on -> claim, argument, one objection, verdict
Discuss -> doctrine, rival, objection, reply, verdict
Critically examine -> two objections, each with reply and residual problem
Can X be accepted? -> NAME THE TEST first, apply it, then judge
Does X leave room for Y? -> what X entails, what Y requires, can they co-exist
How far is X distinctive -> a degree judgment plus a distinctiveness test

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VERDICT FORMULAS (adapt, never reproduce mechanically)

ASYMMETRIC -> the diagnosis survives, the remedy does not
CRITERION -> by consent and equal citizenship, theocratic sovereignty fails
FORM/SUBSTANCE -> the form is kept; the conditions worth having are not
CROSS-TYOLOGY -> who decides, plus why they are obeyed
DILEMMA -> answer propaganda by contestable institutions, not censorship

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CLOSING THESIS -> democracy's superiority is not guaranteed wisdom; it is equal standing, public justification and institutionalised correction of error.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Institutional form axes inside constitutional government

PARLIAMENTARY -> executive-legislative fusion plus collective responsibility

PRESIDENTIAL -> separate mandate, fixed tenure and stronger separation

TRADE-OFF -> removability and coordination versus stability and deadlock

UNITARY -> sub-unit powers are delegated and legally withdrawable

FEDERAL -> centre and units hold constitutionally divided competences

FUSION/SEPARATION -> coordination must coexist with checks and review

DECENTRALISATION -> subsidiarity, local knowledge and participation

CONTROL -> no institutional axis by itself proves democratic legitimacy

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Non-democratic regime families and the six democratic pathologies

DICTATORSHIP -> concentrated rule without regular competitive accountability

AUTHORITARIANISM -> restricted pluralism, opposition and public discussion

TOTALITARIANISM -> comprehensive ideology, mobilisation and party-state penetration

PATHOLOGIES -> majority tyranny | elite capture | instability/short-termism
populist anti-pluralism | propaganda | bureaucratic domination

COUNTERWEIGHTS -> rights | opposition | review | plural media | transparency
decentralisation | realistic alternation in power

VERDICT -> democracy's strength is corrigibility, not immunity from error